

shortage of patent lawyers in Europe. Now, he believes India is heading for a tipping point in the next three years, when the value of an IPR attorney will truly be discovered. This event, he believes will be marked by the verdict on the Novartis-Ranbaxy case. "The judicial system in India is yet to learn how to pass judgement on an IPR case," he says.

His team of 250 people are divided among 1. IT & Telecom, 2. Pharmaceutical & Biotechnology and 3. Energy, Oil & Gas in the ratio of approximately 10:10:5 respectively. He believes the most promise lies in Energy, Oil & Gas.

Potential employers

Engineers, biotechnologists and scientists in this field are usually employed at companies or institutes where they are involved in research and development. The objective of these employers is to find a unique way to solve a problem, gain the intellectual property rights to that solution and then market it.

A large number of organizations outsource their legal service requirements to centers in India. Technology Professionals can seek employment in either captive centers or third party units.

❑ Captive centers

An emerging trend in the industry has been the off-shoring of legal services by foreign law firms establishing units also known as captive units in India. Captive units are the preferred mode of outsourcing for organizations outsourcing high-end critical work. Most foreign law firms in India operate through this structure for want of greater control on areas related to their core competence and business. Issues relating to client confidentiality and risks of unauthorized practice of law are also some of the key reasons for operating through the Captive units.

❑ Third-party units

These service-providers are law firms that either cater to domestic or foreign companies. The law firms themselves could be a foreign company with an arm in India. Many of them provide off-shore services to foreign companies. Third-party units have the advantage of greater flexibility as well as greater expertise

Examples for Captive centres

GE	Amazon
Sun	IBM
Microsoft	Ranbaxy
Cisco	Dr Reddy's

Sample job description

Responsibilities:

- Responsible for evaluating compounds in vitro and cellular models
- Development of newer and innovative methods of testing compounds using the methods of molecular biology, gene expression, cell biology and enzymology
- Experimentation using the methods of biochemistry and cell and molecular biology
- Management and maintenance of the cell culture facility
- Management and maintenance of the radioactivity facility and the radiation

safety program

- Supervision and training of scientists
- Participates in cross-functional compound development efforts as applicable
- Participates in the selection, contracting, and day-to-day management of external suppliers involved in the analysis of compounds.
- High quality scientific reading/writing
- Maintenance and protection of intellectual property (Research schemes, journals, analytical data, material/product safety data sheets etc).
- Participates as appropriate in the human resources activities of the

department (staffing, training, performance management, and employee development).

Qualifications/Requirements/Skills:

- Ph.D., in Biological Science in the broad areas of molecular biology, cell biology and biochemistry or immunology with 8+ years of relevant, hands-on experience.
- Experience in management of personnel
- Ability to work independently and flexibly and to adapt to changing priorities.
- Excellent interpersonal skills